Gold

Worth · shine · celebration

Gold can be a wedding ring, a picture frame, an autumn birch, wallpaper from grandmother's room or the gold paper on a chocolate that at twelve you carefully smoothed with your fingernail. One time it is festive and warming. Another time it feels as if it wanted you to perform something. What does it shine for you, and what do you see in it?

This page does not tell you what gold means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how you paint with it, where its reputation comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

Gold is not one colour from a tube. It is an impression of metallic shine. Real gold, imitations and colours with metallic particles behave differently and a lot depends on the light. A yellow paint lacks shine, and a metallic paint changes according to where you look at it from.

Gold cannot be mixed so that it glitters. Yellow with ochre and a tip of brown gives a golden **shade**, not a golden **shine**. Shine comes from metallic pigments, gold leaf or from a ground that reflects light.

What to prepare



Yellow
The basis for a golden shade.



Ochre
Warms yellow and gives it depth.



Brown
By the tip, for antique gold.



White
For champagne and light golden tones.



Metallic gold paint
A ready-made paint with metallic particles for real shine.



Black
Really just a touch, for gold-green and matt ones.

A shade, or a shine?

On a screen even the best gold is only a shade. Shine is recognised only on paper, when you move your head and the colour changes.

So try gold paint for crafts on paper and look at it from several directions. **Only then decide whether a yellow shade is enough for you or whether you want metal.**

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What the additions do



Yellow

Lightens and makes it glow. Add it when gold looks brownish.





Ochre

Shifts it to a warmer gold with a softer tint.





Brown

Shifts it to antique gold. Just a drop.





Red

Shifts it to a coppery gold. Just a trace.





Green

Shifts it to gold-green, autumnal. Just a trace.





White

Lightens it to champagne and pearly.



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Ten golds to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large heap of paint. The strength of pigments differs, so **take the proportions as a starting point for experimenting**. Shine is added only by metallic paint.

Basic gold



Yellow and ochre. A shade without shine.

Antique gold



Yellow, ochre and a tip of brown. Muted and well weathered.

Champagne



Yellow and more white. Delicate and airy.

Rich gold



Yellow and a trace of red. Warming and striking.

Matt gold



Yellow, ochre and a tip of black. Muted and calm.

Honey



Yellow, ochre and a trace of red. Soft and sweet.

Gold-green



Yellow and a trace of green. Autumn leaves and olives.

Coppery gold



Ochre, red and brown. Warm and metallic.

Light gold



Yellow, white and ochre. Soft and powdery.

Metallic



A ready-made metallic paint and a tip of black. Shine and depth.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

Gold does not have **a stripe of its own** in the rainbow. It is an impression, not a wavelength. We mostly interpret it as a warmer, shinier counterpart of yellow. In some current approaches it accompanies the theme of **self-worth** and the solar plexus, sometimes the crown chakra too. The assignments differ.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?



Gold · next to yellow and the crown

Worth and shine. Ask yourself. What is really precious to me and to whom do I not need to prove it?

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Chakras and gold

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The third chakra Manipura is linked in the classical texts with yellow and fire. Gold is added to it only in modern interpretations. It is sometimes linked also with the crown chakra and the light above the head, similar to the golden halo in icons.

That does not mean gold is the colour of people who are “higher up”. And it need not mean that whoever loves gold seeks recognition. Gold can just be a beauty that delights you.

When gold does you good. You feel warm and festive in it. A gold piece of jewellery, a frame or a lamp gives you a feeling of worth without shouting.

When gold does not do you good. It feels loud to you or looks like needless luxury. These are not proofs of the state of a chakra. It is information about your relationship to shine.

Worth that needs no applause

- **Put it beside**
  A gold paper or piece of jewellery next to a colour that attracts you. Notice them for a while without looking for the right meaning.
- **Take it in your hand**
  A ring, a coin or gold foil. Ask what you consider valuable today.
- **Put it on**
  One gold detail on simple clothing. A chain, a button or earrings.
- **Put it in a room**
  A gold frame or candlestick. A gold frame does not behave like a gold wall.
- **Paint it**
  One gold line on dark paper. Notice the hand, the pressure and whether you want to go on.
- **Look at the light**
  An autumn birch or a lamp by a window. Gold can exist even without paint, simply in the light.

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When there is already too much gold

Worth does not have to shine. Perhaps you are used to showing how much you can do, and nobody has asked you whether you still enjoy it. **You do not need more gold.** You need to invite quieter colours that do not have to prove anything.

- **With white or cream**
  Do I allow myself a calm that does not have to shine?
- **With brown**
  Do I have support and earthiness beneath the shine?
- **With green**
  Is there room for breath and growth?
- **With black**
  Do I see a clear contrast that helps me tell things apart?

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. It is not about measuring chakras. You notice how the relationship of colours affects you and what theme it reminds you of.

Picture it with an example

Next to gold other colours light up. A dark blue feels deep, black festive, cream soft. **These are possibilities of personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add the colour because you are missing warmth, or do you not need it because calm is enough for you? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine.

In the classical seven-colour map gold has no eighth place.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make a pretty picture, we often reach for gold when we want to **emphasise something precious**, or when we need **a little celebration**. We do not always know why, though. Sometimes we know exactly, other times not at all. Both are fine.

What may be hiding behind a gold stroke

The same gold line on paper can mean **something completely different every time**, depending on what is going on in us at the moment. That is why there is no point in reading a painting like a test with a single correct answer.

Celebration.

Scattered glittering strokes. Like when a room lights up.

Worth.

A gold frame around something you care about. Emphasis on what you want to protect.

Warmth.

Soft gold areas near the centre. A colour that warms.

The longing for recognition.

A sharp glitter on the edge, often in a visible place. A palm raised in a crowd.

Autumn and farewell.

Gold-green and ochre areas that dissolve. Something is ending and it is beautiful.

Joy in shine.

The pure taste of metal and light. No hidden meaning.

Gold in a painting. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, **it can**, but **it does not have to**. A gold stroke is not automatically a message about vanity or spirituality. It can mean celebration, worth, warmth, the longing for recognition and simple joy in shine. The amount of gold alone does not determine your state. That holds even when a child uses it.

While working you do not have to decide what exactly it means. Notice the hand, the pressure and whether you want to go on. Meaning comes only in connection with **your experience**.

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I want it on the canvas, but I don't dare put it on myself

A painting and a dress ask two completely different things of you. Gold in a painting can be warm and beautiful, and still you do not feel like wearing gold jewellery. Or the other way round. A gold frame and gold earrings do not exclude each other.

Imagine the same gold on three women. On a bride, on a singer and on a teenage girl. With the first you say “celebration”, with the second “stage”, with the third “what is she trying to say?”. **The colour has not changed. Your expectations have.**

A golden wardrobe is not automatically a sign of vanity or luxury. First of all it is the wardrobe of a particular woman.

When gold takes over the space

First let the hand work. **Gold does not have to cover anything.** If you are afraid it will ruin everything, try it first on a small paper or hold a gold cut-out against the painting. You will see the change without having to make it permanent right away.

Three things worth noticing

- **SHAPE**

A line, an area, or glitter?

A thin gold line can connect or emphasise something. A large area can create warmth as well as ostentation. While working you do not have to decide what exactly it means. Only later can you ask whether the stroke meant celebration, worth or just pleasure in shine.

- **WEIGHT**

Warming, or loud?

If the gold feels pleasantly warming, leave it alone for a while and watch its shape. If an area is too loud, open a smaller muted place or add a matt layer. If everything is glossy, add a difference of surface, direction of strokes or lightness.

- **COURAGE**

You do not have to wrap everything straight away

Courage in painting does not mean you have to intervene in everything at once. If you want a striking accent, try one line or a small circle. If you keep covering the previous layers, notice the feeling of covering itself. The interpretation can wait.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter how the gold stroke looks. What matters is what you feel while making it and what is happening in your life at that moment. **Two identical paintings can have a completely different meaning.** One came from a feeling of celebration, the other after a day when you wanted to show yourself. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps later you will connect the painting with a period when you felt valued. Perhaps with a decision that gave you strength. Or you will keep seeing in it mainly a beautiful glitter. In self-reflection inspired by art therapy what counts is the connection of the painting, your experience and a specific period of life. Gold by itself does not know your story.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at what you have painted and it tells you nothing. In a week, a month or a year, though, it may suddenly dawn on you. That is fine. **The painting will wait until you are ready to understand it.**

If very strong or painful feelings appear while painting, do not stay alone with them. Talk about them with someone close or with a therapist. This page does not replace professional care.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour. We are not born with a ready-made list “gold = this”, and yet they tend to be surprisingly similar. They are usually made up of three layers: **the body**, **culture** and **what we have lived through ourselves**.

From the body

Gold is the colour of **the sun, honey and autumn light**. The eye catches it quickly because it shines and changes. That helps explain why gold can have a relationship to worth and to attention.

From culture

In most of the world gold is linked with **worth, power and celebration**. A medal, a crown, a ring, a halo. At the same time it can mean ostentation and greed. In the chapter on cultures we will look at this in more detail.

From what you have lived

Grandmother's gold chain, the gold paper on a chocolate, wallpaper from the seventies, a first gold ring. These memories decide the most. **Two women can look at the same gold** and one feels warmth, the other ostentation.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is actually “gold” and what is your story about it. You can ask yourself now. **What does gold connect with first for me and where do I know that from?**

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Stories

Gold has several stories worth untangling. They show where the colour ends and where begins what people make of it.

The gold mask

The tomb of Tutankhamun was discovered in **1922** and the gold funerary mask was uncovered in 1925, when researchers opened the innermost of the coffins. It weighs roughly ten kilograms of gold and is inlaid with lapis lazuli, carnelian and glass.

In the Egyptian image gold is a sign of the divine body, which is not subject to time. Gold here is not wealth for show. It is **an image of something meant to last**.

El Dorado

The legend of the golden king arose in the records of Spanish conquerors in the 16th century. It speaks of a ruler who covered himself in gold dust and washed it off in a sacred lake. Later versions relate it to Lake Guatavita and the anointing of a new ruler of the Muisca people.

In **1969** a gold miniature of a vessel with a seated figure and attendants was found, today in the Museo del Oro in Bogotá. Historians argue about how much of the story is reality and how much the Spaniards added. Gold became **a promise that led people further than beyond the edge of a map**.

Gold that joins

Kintsugi is the Japanese technique of repairing broken ceramics with urushi lacquer and powder of gold, silver or platinum. The seams are not hidden but highlighted. According to one theory it is connected with the 15th century and the shogun Ashikaga Yoshimasa.

The technique is close to the idea of wabi-sabi, that is, the acceptance of imperfection. Gold here is not a symbol of perfection. It is **a visible trace of the fact that something was repaired**.

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Emotions and feelings

The same gold can awaken **celebration** in one of us and **pressure** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Joy

A feeling that **something has lit up**.

And why?

Golden light, bubbles in champagne, shine on water. Gold can link with moments when things are good and need no explaining.

Ask yourself

"When did something last light up for me for no reason?"

Pride

A feeling that **you have something to be proud of**.

And why?

A gold medal, a diploma, a win. Pride in your own work can be healthy. It becomes unpleasant when it turns into the only currency.

And what if I asked you now?

"What am I really proud of, even if nobody sees it?"

The longing for recognition

A feeling that you want **to be seen and appreciated**.

And why?

Gold shine draws the eye. The wish to be seen is not bad. What is interesting is to notice when it turns into a condition.

And try answering now

"Whose praise would I really need today?"

Nostalgia

A feeling that **something beautiful is drifting away**.

And why?

Golden light before sunset, leaves in autumn, old photographs. Gold can evoke a memory that both warms and hurts.

And now one question for you

"What do I look at in my thoughts, even though it is no longer there?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Self-worth

A feeling that **you are worth it**, even when you show nothing.

And why?

Gold is a symbol of worth. A person's worth, though, is not measured in grams. The colour can remind you that you deserve beauty and care without winning anything.

Ask yourself

"What would I give myself if I did not have to prove anything?"

Festivity

A feeling that **it is a special time**.

And why?

A wedding, a birthday, a Christmas table. Gold accompanies moments we want to remember. Without an occasion it can feel exaggerated.

And what if I asked you now?

"What would I celebrate today, even if nobody knew?"

Fear of ostentation

A feeling that in a different colour **you would be too visible**.

And why?

When you want a gold piece of jewellery but always leave it in the drawer because "it is too much on me", it is precisely this worry that deserves attention. If you simply do not like gold, though, you do not have to re-educate yourself.

And try answering now

"Do I choose restraint because I love it, or because I am afraid?"

Warmth

A feeling that **there is warmth** that wants nothing.

And why?

Honey, a candle, the golden hour. Warmth is entirely different from shine. A quiet gold tends to be matt and muted.

And now one question for you

"Where does something simple warm me today?"

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My gold is not the same as your gold

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **A gold ring**
  For one love, for another duty.
- **A gold frame**
  For one protection, for another a museum.
- **Gold paper**
  For one childhood, for another wrapping.
- **A gold leaf**
  For one autumn, for another an ending.
- **A gold medal**
  For one joy, for another pressure.

Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you need a little celebration that does not have to be earned by anything. Or you miss light in a grey period. **A liking for gold has no single hidden meaning.**

Does it really flatter?

Gold jewellery looks different on different skin tones and in different light. A warm gold may match a warm skin undertone better, but that is not a rule. Try two shades by your face in daylight and notice the whole impression, not just whether your skin glows.

When to take gold away

When a particular whole weighs on you, you lose your bearings in it or it keeps reminding you of expectations you do not want to meet. Start with one change. Matt instead of glossy, smaller instead of large. **Gold can be your choice. It does not have to be your duty.**

Ask yourself

"Which sentence about gold is loudest in me? Whose is it actually?"

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Gold in cultures and traditions

Gold is a colour that people long thought was “obvious”. Worth, power, celebration. Behind its reputation, though, are **more stories about trade, faith and collecting than about the colour itself**. Let us look at a few places and read them well.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how gold is read in different **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, using it as an image, not as a guide. What is verified history and what a later interpretation, I say in each part.

Gold in different cultures

Egypt

The gold funerary mask of Tutankhamun weighs roughly ten kilograms and is inlaid with lapis lazuli, carnelian and glass. In the Egyptian image gold symbolises the divine and the afterlife. The mask shows the king in the form of Osiris, the god of the afterlife.

From a tomb where gold was not meant to tempt but to endure.

Gold here is **an image of immortality**.

Byzantium

In Byzantine icons the gold background is a sign that the scene takes place in heaven. The gold glory, the halo, symbolises according to Orthodox theology the uncreated light. The halo appears in Christian art from the fourth century.

From churches where gold was not about money but about light.

Gold here is **a window into heaven**.

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Japan

Kintsugi repairs broken ceramics with urushi lacquer and powder of gold, silver or platinum. The seams remain visible. The technique is close to the idea of wabi-sabi.

From a tea room where a cracked bowl became a more beautiful bowl.

Gold here is **a trace that says it was treasured**.

California

The gold rush in California began on 24 January 1848, when James Marshall found gold at Sutter's Mill in Coloma. By the end of 1848 about six thousand people had arrived, in 1849 roughly ninety thousand and by 1855 at least three hundred thousand.

From a land where gold attracted more people than any other colour.

Gold here is **a dream that draws whole crowds**.

Gold in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at gold **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and a source of inspiration, not a healing guide.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the traditional system of five elements yellow is linked with earth, the centre, the spleen and stomach and worries. Metal is the element of white and autumn. Gold is in the tradition often read as yellow with the shine of metal. That is my own reflection, not a classical table.

How it relates to the colour gold. For our story the image can carry the thought that worth needs soil. Gold jewellery is beautiful, but it warms only when you have certainty beneath you. **Gold without support can be just shine.**

And what if I asked you now?

“What is real support for me and what is only decoration?”

The centre and food

The yellow earth is in tradition linked with how we nourish ourselves. A gold table does not feed. A warm and matt gold can feel warming, whereas a sharp and glossy one draws attention. Try to tell apart what does you good.

Autumn and letting go

A golden autumn tree is beautiful and lets its leaves go. **You do not have to choose one position for ever.**

Traditional Chinese medicine uses the elements as an image. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace a doctor.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. It describes a person by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are not assigned to the doshas uniformly in the classical texts, so here you read **modern interpretations**, not an old table.

How it relates to the colour gold. In Ayurveda-inspired work we can ask about warmth, shine and heaviness. Gold does not give the same experience in every material. A matt gold fabric and a glossy sheet of metal are rather different worlds.

Pitta

This is how a woman is described who is purposeful, quick and thorough, and flares up easily. A matt and soft gold can feel warming, a sharp shine can irritate.

- **Matt and soft**
  Warming without shouting.
- **Beware of shine**
  A sharp contrast can be an extra stimulus.

Vata

This is how a woman is described who is imaginative and quick, but restless, and is often cold. Gold in a warm fabric or a candle gives a feeling of home. **It is best to notice how you really feel in it.**

- **Warm gold**
  A candle, honey, a soft fabric.
- **Evening**
  Golden light instead of harsh.

Kapha

This is how a woman is described who is calm, steady and patient, but who easily becomes heavy. A gold accent can enliven, but large areas weigh a wall down. **Add movement and light to them.**

- **A small accent**
  A frame or jewellery.
- **A light base**
  Lightens a heavy environment.

We will therefore not make gold a universal ban or a remedy for a particular dosha. More interesting is whether a particular form brings you comfort or weighs on you.

An online test will not reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

Jung did not describe gold as a separate colour. What I write next is my own reflection in the spirit of his thought, not his statement. In alchemy gold is the goal of the work and Jung read alchemy as an image of inner transformation. In such a reading gold can mean **what has been born in a person after long work**.

How it relates to the colour gold. In symbolic language you can read gold as **the colour of worth that arose from experience**. When you think about it, ask what in it is yours and what belongs to the expectations of others.

What you can take from it. Jung did not want colours to be made into a dictionary. **We always ask what it means for you.** The same gold can be a support for one woman and pressure for another. Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic framework, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. In feng shui interpretations gold and metallic colours are often assigned to the element of metal and yellow to earth. Schools differ in the assignment, so take it as one of the possibilities.

Gold is like jewellery

A little adds shine to a space, a whole room turns it into a shop window. A gold detail works when there is room to rest around it.

Simple tips

- **Start small**
  A gold frame, candlestick or lamp. A gold frame does not behave like a gold wall.
- **Choose matt**
  A matt gold feels quieter than a glossy one.
- **Give it light**
  Warm light changes gold more than other colours.
- **Give it wood**
  Wood, linen and wool add body.
- **Try it in daylight**
  See how it looks in the morning and in the evening.
- **Try textiles first**
  Before you repaint a wall, try a cushion or a larger sample.

What people say and what holds true

MYTH Gold is only a sign of wealth.

TRUTH In many cultures it is also the colour of celebration, holiness and victory. The gold background of icons is often interpreted as light, not as money.

MYTH Gold will turn black over time.

TRUTH Gold does not react with oxygen or with sulphur in the air, unlike silver. That is why the colour gold has long been linked with permanence.

MYTH The more gold, the more luxury.

TRUTH Rather the opposite. A little gold looks refined, a lot feels heavy. One gold detail, such as a frame or a lamp, is often enough.

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What gold works well with

- **Black**
  A festive and firm pair. Watch the quantity.
- **Dark blue**
  A deep and calm contrast that softens gold.
- **Cream**
  Gentler than a sharp white. Gold feels soft in it.
- **Green**
  Bottle green and matt gold are a classic.
- **Brown**
  A warm, earthy impression with shine on top.
- **Red**
  Festive and striking. Watch that they do not pull against each other.

Elements

- **Metal**
  Gold is its natural representative. Watch that it does not dominate.
- **Earth**
  Brown and yellow warm it.
- **Water**
  Dark blue and black deepen it.
- **Wood**
  Green and wood enliven it.

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Feng shui room by room

Living room

What works. A gold frame, candlestick or lamp can add a festive detail.

What to watch for. When all the mirrors, frames and candlesticks are gold, the room feels like a shop window.

A simple tip. Leave one more striking piece and calmer materials around it.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Gold taps or bowls can turn a meal into a celebration.

What to watch for. Shine shows fingerprints and ages quickly when it is polished.

A simple tip. Pay attention to the material and maintenance. A matt surface behaves differently from a glossy one.

Bedroom

What works. A gold lamp or a soft fabric can give a room a warming impression.

What to watch for. Glossy surfaces reflect light and can disturb the calm of the evening.

A simple tip. Try a matt and muted gold. Let the light be warm.

Children's room

What works. A gold star, little crown or frame can be play for a child.

What to watch for. A gold wall can become heavy. A child may not want it.

A simple tip. Let the child choose and start with a small detail.

Study

What works. A gold detail on the desk can remind you of what matters to you.

What to watch for. Glossy surfaces around a screen cause reflections.

A simple tip. Leave one accent, mute the rest.

Bathroom

What works. A gold tap or mirror frame can give a warm impression.

What to watch for. Limescale and fingerprints show more on glossy gold than on silver.

A simple tip. Consider a matt finish and diffused light.

And try answering now

“Why do I want gold at home? What is it meant to bring me, warmth, celebration, or recognition?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

With gold people speak of “golden light” and a “high frequency”. It sounds as if it had its own number that can be read. A gold colour **reflects** light, a gold lamp **emits** light. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to put **miraculous promises** aside. A gold wall or a gold filter is not in itself a therapeutic light method.

Gold is not light with a frequency of its own

The golden impression arises from a combination of colour shade and shine. Gold reflects mainly longer wavelengths, which is why it looks yellow and warming. Also the warm light of a candle or bulb can make a surface look golden. The colour of an object, the intensity of the light and the feeling of the surroundings are connected, but they are not interchangeable.

Does gold absorb energy?

In optics we speak of the reflection and absorption of radiation. A gold surface reflects more light than a dark one. It does not follow, though, that a gold piece of jewellery “charges” or “balances” anything. **Those are spiritual or personal interpretations**, not a continuation of the same physical rule.

Golden light and the daily rhythm

The golden hour before sunset is beloved by photographers because the light is soft and warm. Warm light in the evening can be pleasant. Bright-light therapy for seasonal depression uses designated devices and a specific procedure, not the colour gold. If you are considering it, consult a doctor.

When it is pleasant to switch off the shine

Too many glossy surfaces can dazzle. Some people enjoy shine, others need calm. You do not have to learn to love glitter for your work with colours to be right.

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Libra, Sagittarius or Pisces? The astrotype is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you really want to go into **depth**, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth are also important, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we stay only at the edge of what relates to colours.

Astrology does not assign gold unambiguously. It is most often linked with the Sun (centre, vitality), sometimes with Jupiter (abundance) or Venus (beauty and worth). In alchemy gold is the symbol of the Sun. Sources disagree on this, so take it as inspiration. Depending on how the planet of your sign relates to gold, it may feel close to you or distant. Find your sign (the dates are approximate and vary by year) and read what gold may say to you.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your gold

gold · red · antique gold

A gold that **gives you shine without needless noise**.

Aries is linked with Mars, fire and the start of spring. Gold is for it like glowing metal, **strength with shine**. Gold with red may suit you better than a pastel.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to be seen and do not want to show off. It suits a celebration, a performance and a journey.

With Aries the strength tends to lie in the first step. Gold can add **a goal worth the journey**.

Shadow victory as the only currency

In the shadow Aries counts only wins. Gold becomes a medal without which it does not feel quite whole.

Aries is afraid that if it did not win, it would be nothing. So it keeps competing and does not find out that it would be valuable even without a medal.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **do one thing in which there is no competing**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red or brown.

red · brown · champagne

Red and brown give gold body and support.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Gold gives you a warming and self-assured impression. Antique gold and matt are closest.

In everyday life

Take a gold piece of jewellery and ask what you really want to start today.

*When you feel like competing, give yourself **a matt gold piece of jewellery and five minutes at the window**. You do not have to prove anything.*

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your gold

matt gold · brown · champagne

Gold as **honey, linen and the warmth of home**.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. Gold suits it naturally, as a material, not as an idea. Gold jewellery, honey-coloured wood and silk are **luxury without shouting**.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Gold can support joy in touch and good quality. It suits where you want comfort and elegance at the same time.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the surface. A matt gold and a glossy sheet of metal feel entirely different.

Shadow possessions as security

In the shadow Taurus measures safety by things. Gold becomes a safe that must not be opened.

Taurus likes security and gold promises it. Only then nothing new comes, because everything is locked away.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **give one thing away and not regret it**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add green and cream.

green · cream · antique gold

Green and cream add freshness and warmth to gold.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Gold gives you a calm and trustworthy impression. Matt suits better than glossy.

In everyday life

Take in your hand something gold that you like and notice how it feels under your fingers.

A gold lamp and a good book. ***Treat yourself to them without apology.***

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your gold

champagne · rich gold · sky blue

A gold that **lights up your ideas**.

Gemini is an air sign linked with Mercury, curiosity and speech. Gold fits it as a spark in thought. A gold pen, **a gold sheet of paper and champagne after a good idea**.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you are looking for room for ideas. It suits a diary, a work desk and a bag.

With Gemini the strength tends to lie in ideas and words. Gold can add **depth and seriousness**.

Shadow glitter instead of content

In the shadow Gemini focus on the shine of words and forget the matter. Gold becomes packaging without contents.

Gemini like to catch attention and gold helps them. Only then nobody knows what they actually wanted to say.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **write one sentence without decoration**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury yellow or light blue.

yellow | sky blue | white

Yellow and blue add clarity of thought and airiness.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Gold gives you a lighter and more radiant impression. Champagne and rich gold are the lightest.

In everyday life

Take a gold pen and write down three things that interested you today.

*When you feel you are playing a role, give yourself **a moment of quiet with a gold paper**. You do not have to joke about everything.*

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your gold

matt gold · silver · cream

Gold as **the warmth of a home lamp**.

Cancer is a water sign linked with the Moon, home and feeling. Gold may feel to it like light in a window. A matt gold and cream may remind you of **the home you return to**.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you need to warm up. It suits a bedroom, a house and clothing.

With Cancer the strength tends to lie in empathy. Gold can add **permission to let yourself be looked after**.

Shadow protection as a golden cage

In the shadow Cancer builds a home so beautiful that nobody wants to leave. Gold turns into a cage.

Cancers fear loss and gold promises them that everything will last. Then nobody sees that they need something too.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **invite one person and let them have a look**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Moon silver and cream.

silver · cream · milky

Silver and cream add golden light and openness.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Gold gives you an impression of warmth and care. Muted and soft shades suit.

In everyday life

In the evening light a candle and sit for a while without tasks.

*When you are tired of keeping watch, put on **a gold shawl and remind yourself** that rest belongs to you too.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your gold

gold · red · rich gold

A gold that **lets you shine**.

Leo is a fire sign ruled by the Sun. Gold is its natural colour, like a crown and the sun. Gold dresses, striking lipstick and **lots of light around you**.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to be seen and at the same time keep calm. It suits an evening, a performance and a celebration.

With Leo the strength tends to lie in creativity and generosity. Gold can add **quiet nobility**.

Shadow radiance without a source

In the shadow Leo shines so that tiredness is not seen. Gold becomes the mask of the sun.

Leo needs recognition and gold gives it an impression of shine. When the gazes disappear, emptiness arrives.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **choose a gold that delights you**, even if nobody is going to judge it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Sun orange or deep blue.

orange · dark blue · red

Orange and dark blue add warmth and depth to gold.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Gold gives you dignity. Rich gold and antique gold suit better than champagne.

In everyday life

Put on something gold today with one calm thing.

*When you feel you have to shine, take **a gold piece of jewellery and a black coat**.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your gold

matt gold · gold-green · white

Gold as **a field before harvest**.

Virgo is an earth sign linked with Mercury, order and care for detail. Gold suits it in natural and delicate forms. **A golden ear of wheat, small jewellery and fine lines** without needless decoration.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to tidy both the space and your head. It suits a work desk, a wardrobe and a pantry.

With Virgo the strength tends to lie in attention and order. Gold can add **a little forgiveness**.

Shadow perfection as the price

In the shadow Virgo polishes until nothing gleams. Gold becomes the yardstick of flawlessness.

Virgo is strict with itself and gold makes that easier. Only joy never arrives.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **leave a fingerprint on one thing**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury grey and green.

grey · green · white

Grey and green add order and calm.

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Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

Gold gives you a delicate and careful impression. A matt gold suits better than a glossy one.

In everyday life

Put a golden ear of wheat or a small object on your desk and fix nothing on it.

*When you feel strict, try **leaving one thing imperfect** and looking at it in warm light.*

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your gold

champagne · powder pink · silver

A gold that **suits you in gentleness and style**.

Libra is an air sign ruled by Venus. Gold suits it in elegant and balanced forms. Champagne and powder pink like **an evening dress with delicate jewellery**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want beauty and balance without shouting. It suits a home, clothing and work.

With Libra the strength tends to lie in taste and diplomacy. Gold can add **permission to stay with your own**.

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Shadow beauty as an obligation

In the shadow Libra chooses gold according to what fits and forgets what it wants. Shine becomes a duty.

Libra wants everything to fit together. So it puts off its own taste, because it might disturb the whole.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **choose one thing that fits nothing, and like it**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green and powder pink.

green · powder pink · white

Green and powder pink add calm and reality.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Gold gives you a pleasant and balanced impression. Champagne suits your manner best.

In everyday life

Try a gold bowl or scarf on the table and notice what you like and what you merely do not mind.

*When everything feels too perfect to you, give yourself **one thing in a softer shade** that has a voice of its own.*

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your gold

antique gold · wine · black

A gold that **allows you depth without drama**.

Scorpio is a water sign linked with Mars and Pluto, depth and transformation. Gold is for it like gold in a deep mine, **hidden worth**. Antique gold and wine red may be closer to you than champagne.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to be close, but in your own way. It suits as a private detail.

With Scorpio the strength tends to lie in depth and loyalty. Gold can add **calm after the storm**.

Shadow a treasure under lock

In the shadow Scorpio hides the most precious thing so deep that not even it can reach it. Gold turns into buried treasure.

Scorpios find it hard to open up after being hurt. Gold means to them that worth is safe, but nobody has seen it.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **take one thing out and put it in the light**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add gold with dark wine.

wine · red · black

Wine and red add depth and warmth to gold.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Gold gives you a calm depth behind a mysterious impression. Antique gold is closest.

In everyday life

Try having gold just for yourself in something nobody sees.

*When you want to withdraw, put **a gold piece of jewellery under your clothes** and let it be your secret.*

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your gold

gold · brown · orange

Gold as **the sun above the road**.

Sagittarius is a fire sign linked with Jupiter, freedom and distances. Gold suits it as the colour of a sunset over the horizon. Brown and orange like **a road that leads home**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

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What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to set out but have somewhere to return to. It suits a journey, nature and a café.

With Sagittarius the strength tends to lie in optimism and élan. Gold can add **an awareness of where you came from**.

Shadow chasing something better

In the shadow Sagittarius looks for a gold mine and forgets the golden hour that is already here. Gold becomes a horizon that recedes.

Sagittarians love freedom and gold promises them that there is more behind the next hill. Only then nobody knows what they already have.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **list three things you have and add nothing to them**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue or green.

blue | green | champagne

Blue and green add reach and élan to gold.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

Gold gives you a friendly and open impression. Rich gold and brown suit better than champagne.

In everyday life

Take a gold scarf or coin on a journey and put it back in the same place when you return.

*When something feels tight, try **looking to see whether it is only closeness**.*

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Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your gold

antique gold · anthracite · brown

A gold that **lets you be firm and calm**.

Capricorn is an earth sign linked with Saturn, responsibility and perseverance. Gold suits it in muted forms, like **an honour after long work**. Antique gold and anthracite add a maturity that can warm.

What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want to lay a firm foundation. It suits an office, negotiations and long-term plans.

With Capricorn the strength tends to lie in order and perseverance. Antique gold can add **willingness to rest**.

Shadow a reward postponed indefinitely

In the shadow Capricorn puts gold off until the time when it will be “deserved”. Gold becomes a reward that never comes.

Capricorn is afraid that if it indulged itself, it would achieve nothing. Then even shine is just another task.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **treat yourself to one gold thing today**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Saturn grey and cream.

slate · cream · brown

Grey and cream add weight and warmth to gold.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Gold gives you a trustworthy and calm impression. Antique gold works best.

In everyday life

Put a gold button or cufflink on serious clothing.

*When you feel too strict, try **looking at a gold thing and improving nothing**.*

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your gold

champagne · sky blue · silver

Gold as **an unexpected idea** among colours.

Aquarius is an air sign linked with Saturn and Uranus, independence and ideas. Gold belongs to it as an inconspicuous choice that surprises. Champagne next to silver feels like **the colour of a calm future**.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

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What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you want something unusual, but with calm. It suits a poster, a logo and clothing.

With Aquarius the strength tends to lie in originality and perspective. Gold can add **firm ground beneath ideas**.

Shadow distance behind a glossy surface

In the shadow Aquarius hides behind a shine that lets nobody closer. Gold turns into a mirror in which everyone sees only themselves.

Aquarians like to keep their distance and shine makes it easier. Only then the body waits for a touch that does not come.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **take something rough and natural in your hand** and just notice it for a while.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add a cool blue or silver.

sky blue · silver · white

Blue and silver add purity and distance to gold.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Gold gives you an unexpected and friendly impression. Champagne and silver are closest.

In everyday life

Try putting one gold thing in your bag for a week and not explaining it.

*When everything seems too neutral to you, try **telling yourself what you like about it**.*

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Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your gold

champagne · violet-grey · sky blue

Gold as **light on water**.

Pisces is a water sign linked with Jupiter and Neptune, feeling and imagination. Gold can give it warmth and shine in the depths. Champagne and sky blue may remind you of **a sunset over the sea**.

What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Gold can support moments when you need to anchor yourself. It suits a bedroom, a painting and a scent.

With Pisces the strength tends to lie in empathy and imagination. Gold can add **willingness to stand firm even in the current**.

Shadow a dream instead of reality

In the shadow Pisces fall in love with a golden dream and do not see what is real. Gold becomes a veil.

Pisces are sensitive and easily take on other people's ideas. Gold gives them comfort, but not direction.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **have one thing at home that you chose yourself**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add gold with blue or green.

blue green cream

Blue and green add water and soil to gold.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Gold gives you a soft and calm impression. Champagne and sky blue are closest.

In everyday life

In the evening light a candle, take a gold object in your hand and write three sentences about the day.

When you feel like running away, ***hold a gold thing firmly in your hand*** *and return to the room.*

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

- **Seasons**

Gold is the colour of autumn and winter celebrations. Summer leaves it more for the evening, when the sun sets. Ask yourself when you reach for it.

- **Time of day**

The golden hour in the morning and before sunset belongs to gold the most. Noon is too sharp for it and the shine loses its expression.

- **Years of life**

Saturn orbits the Sun in roughly 29 years. Astrology speaks of its returns at roughly 29 and 58 years of age and reads them as times when a person asks what is truly theirs. In those years gold may feel close to you as a reminder of what you have won for yourself, or on the contrary foreign as an image you never wanted. Both are natural. Research by Palmer and Schloss (2010) moreover states that we like colours according to the things and experiences we link with them. Astrology does not rule this out, it just offers another view.

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Colour for your website and business

Yes, mainly where you sell worth, celebration and long durability. Gold promises quality, but can easily feel ostentatious.

In business gold is a colour that **invites trust in exceptionality**, but at the same time carries the label of extravagance. It can feel luxurious, festive, traditional and modern. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into a logo, a website or an advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create **a striking impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Gold can say, for example

"It is valuable." "It is festive." "It is premium." "It is something special."

- **Luxury and celebration.** Gold is often used for jewellery, chocolate, watches and gifts.
- **Prestige.** Awards, medals, cards. Too much gold, though, can feel unattainable.
- **Tradition.** Gold can recall the long history of a brand.
- **Warmth.** A matt gold can feel friendly.
- **Ostentation.** Without a calm companion it can feel like a shop window.

Depending on the shade it also feels different. Champagne is **delicate and modern**, antique gold **traditional and earthy**, rich gold **striking and festive**.

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Simple tips

Keep to measure
A gold accent works better than a gold area. Less shine, more calm.

Show the product
A gold packaging on a gold background disappears. Give it contrast.

Shade by role
Rich gold for celebration, antique gold for tradition, champagne for modern.

Legibility
Gold text on a light background is hard to read. Watch size and contrast.

A human face
Luxury does not have to stand in the doorway with its arms folded. Add clear language.

Colour blindness
About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Dark text on a light background is the safest choice for most people.

Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell worth, celebration or exceptionality, gold can help you.

Jewellery, watches and gifts

Gold here belongs to the material as well as the colour. Watch that the shine does not say more than the product itself.

Confectionery and gastronomy

Gold foil and lettering convey a gift and celebration. For everyday food it can feel exaggerated.

Awards and programmes

A gold medal and a gold card show the highest level. What matters is what is really behind it.

Weddings, celebrations and art

Gold can support a festive impression. Wood and a gentle companion calm it.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Caring for people.** Too much shine can feel unattainable.
- **Playful and light services.** For services promising lightness and playfulness gold can create different expectations.
- **Clinics and counselling.** Ostentation can clash with confidentiality.
- **Long texts on a website.** Gold text on a light background is tiring.
- **Product presentations.** A gold filter can distort the real colours.

Most important is not whether a design looks expensive. It is whether a person understands where they have come and what they can expect.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer, and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the gold?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that gold means worth.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know gold from pralines, cards and watches. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Ferrero Rocher (confectionery)**
  The pralines went on sale in 1979 in Italy and in Europe from 1982. Each is wrapped in golden foil. Michele Ferrero is considered the inventor.
- **American Express (financial services)**
  The gold card appeared in 1966. The company was founded in 1850. The gold colour meant the highest card available.
- **Lindt Gold Bunny (confectionery)**
  The gold bunny was created in 1952. It is wrapped in gold foil with a red ribbon. Aha. Gold makes chocolate into a gift.
- **Rolex Day-Date (watches)**
  Rolex introduced the model in 1956 at the Basel fair. The original watches were made only in 18-carat gold or platinum. In 1965 the first American president to wear the gold Day-Date was Lyndon B. Johnson and Rolex then promoted it as the watch of presidents.

What they have in common is that gold carries a simple message. **The highest level, a special moment.** And it mostly does not outshine what is around it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Gold + red

How it feels

Celebration and fire. Red makes gold glow and gold gives red shine. Together they feel festive and striking.

When it suits

When you want **celebration and courage**.

Specific shades



gold + red
festively



antique gold + wine
strikingly



champagne + coral
dramatically



rich gold + scarlet
warmly



matt gold + brick
muted

In practice

A red dress and gold jewellery. A red wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **black or cream**.

Gold + orange

How it feels

Sunset. Orange warms gold and gold softens orange. Together they feel warming and playful.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and light**.

Specific shades



gold + orange
radiantly



antique gold + terracotta
warmly



champagne + apricot
playfully



rich gold + pumpkin
richly



matt gold + rust
earthy

In practice

An orange jumper and a gold chain. An orange cushion and a gold lamp.

Watch out

Too many warm colours side by side tire. Try **adding green**.

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Gold + yellow

How it feels

Sun and honey. Yellow makes gold glow and gold gives yellow depth. Together they feel joyful and warming.

When it suits

When you want **light and joy**.

Specific shades


gold + yellow
cheerfully


antique gold + ochre
golden


champagne + butter
freshly


rich gold + lemon
radiantly


matt gold + mustard
muted

In practice

A yellow scarf and gold jewellery. A yellow wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

At the same intensity the colours pull against each other. Leave gold **as an accent**.

Gold + green

How it feels

Leaves and shine. Green calms gold and gold gives green a festive air. Together they feel classic and natural.

When it suits

When you want **natural elegance**.

Specific shades


gold + green
naturally


antique gold + bottle green
woodland


champagne + mint
classic


rich gold + emerald
striking


matt gold + sage
quiet

In practice

Bottle green and a gold detail. A green plant in a gold pot.

Watch out

A sharp green next to gold feels loud. **Mute** the greenery.

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Gold + blue

How it feels

Night and light. Blue cools gold and gold makes blue glow. Together they feel calm and noble.

When it suits

When you want **calm and depth**.

Specific shades



gold + blue
calm



antique gold + dark blue
noble



champagne + sky blue
deep



rich gold + cobalt
fresh



matt gold + denim
sober

In practice

A dark blue dress and gold jewellery. A blue wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

Both tend to be strong. Without a warm companion the whole can feel **cold**.

Gold + indigo

How it feels

Night sky. Indigo deepens gold and gold gives indigo light. Together they feel like stars.

When it suits

When you want **depth without heaviness**.

Specific shades



gold + indigo
twilit



antique gold + ink
deep



champagne + dusk blue
firm



rich gold + ultramarine
festive



matt gold + grey-indigo
sober

In practice

An indigo coat and gold buttons. Dark blue and gold in a painting.

Watch out

Dark and glossy can feel sharp. Add **cream**.

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Gold + violet

How it feels

Royal. Violet sets gold off and gold gives violet shine. Together they feel sensual and festive.

When it suits

When you want **sensuality and celebration**.

Specific shades



gold + violet
dreamily



antique gold + plum
festively



champagne + lavender
deeply



rich gold + orchid
richly



matt gold + grey-violet
dusty

In practice

Plum and gold in a dress. Violet jewellery and a gold clasp.

Watch out

Too much violet and gold can feel heavy. Add **a light colour**.

Gold + pink

How it feels

Softness and shine. Pink softens gold and gold gives pink a festive air. Together they feel gentle and elegant.

When it suits

When you want **gentleness with shine**.

Specific shades



gold + pink
gently



antique gold + raspberry
festively



champagne + powder
romantically



rich gold + fuchsia
warmly



matt gold + dusty pink
inconspicuously

In practice

A pink blouse and gold jewellery. A pink wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

Two sweet colours tend to be too sweet. Add **green or grey**.

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Gold + grey

How it feels

Calm and shine. Grey calms gold and gold enlivens grey. Together they feel restrained and modern.

When it suits

When you want **elegance without shouting**.

Specific shades


gold + grey
soberly


antique gold + graphite
elegantly


champagne + silver
lightly


rich gold + slate
modern


matt gold + dove
quietly

In practice

A grey jumper and a gold chain. A grey wall and a gold lamp.

Watch out

Both tend to be calm. Without an accent the whole can feel boring. Add **colour**.

Gold + brown

How it feels

Earth and light. Brown warms gold and gold brightens brown. Together they feel natural and cosy.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and support**.

Specific shades


gold + brown
naturally


antique gold + chocolate
cosily


champagne + beige
soberly


rich gold + caramel
earthy


matt gold + linen
inconspicuously

In practice

A brown coat and gold jewellery. A wooden table and a gold lamp.

Watch out

Two warm colours tend to be heavy. Add **white or cream**.

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Gold + white

How it feels

Pure celebration. White brightens gold and gold gives white shine. Together they feel fresh and festive.

When it suits

When you want **celebration without heaviness**.

Specific shades



gold + white
festively



antique gold + ivory
cleanly



champagne + snow
delicately



rich gold + milky
radiantly



matt gold + bone
muted

In practice

A white dress and gold jewellery. White ceramics with a gold rim.

Watch out

In excess gold drowns out calm. Add **wood or linen**.

Gold + black

How it feels

Evening. Black sets gold off and gold gives black shine. Together they feel festive and luxurious.

When it suits

When you want **celebration with depth**.

Specific shades



gold + black
festively



antique gold + charcoal
richly



champagne + anthracite
dramatically



rich gold + ink black
radiantly



matt gold + soot
muted

In practice

A black dress and gold jewellery. Black packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess it feels like a shop window. Add **one calm surface**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** gold, add **cream**, **grey**, **wood** or **linen**.
- When you want to **enliven** it, add **green**, **blue** or **pink**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **indigo**, **dark blue** or **brown** will help.
- When you want to **make it stand out**, add **black**, **white** or **red**.

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